

CLAT Express - December 2025: Answer Key

Multiple-choice passages

Aravalli Range: Facts and Rulings

1	A. Guru Shikhar, Rajasthan	The booklet names Guru Shikhar, at 1722 m near Mount Abu, as the highest peak, in Rajasthan.
2	A. About 2 billion years	The booklet dates the Aravalli system to about 2 billion years, in the Precambrian era.
3	D. 692 km	The booklet states that the range extends 692 km from Gujarat (Champaner) through Rajasthan and Haryana to Delhi.
4	B. Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A	The booklet lists copper, zinc, lead and silver as minerals and separately names the Luni and Banas as rivers from the range, so the rivers do not explain the minerals.
5	C. I-D, II-C, III-A, IV-B	The booklet links Champaner to the Gujarat start, Raisina Hill to the Delhi end, Guru Shikhar to the highest peak, and the Luni to the range's rivers.
6	A. I and II only	The booklet defines the hill and range thresholds in statements I and II, while it bans mining in core or inviolate areas, which makes statement III wrong.
7	B. Only two	Statements I and III match the booklet, while Guru Shikhar lies in Rajasthan, not Haryana.

Key features check

1	A. 125 days	The booklet states the bill guarantees 125 days per household per financial year, up from 100 days under MGNREGA.
2	A. Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A	The booklet says the suspension is allowed to ensure availability of agricultural labour during sowing and harvesting seasons.
3	D. I-B, II-C, III-D, IV-A	The correct pairs are I-B, II-A, III-C and IV-D, in line with the scheme descriptions in the booklet.
4	B. I and III only	Statement II is incorrect because the booklet lists four national priorities, not five.
5	C. Only three	Statement IV is incorrect because the bill envisages weekly wage payments, while the 15-day deadline applied to MGNREGA.
6	A. 90%	The booklet states the Centre-State ratio is 90:10 for North-Eastern and Himalayan States.
7	D. Digital Banking Infrastructure	The four priorities are Water Security, Core Rural Infrastructure, Livelihood-related Infrastructure and Special Works for Extreme Weather Events.
8	A. 15 days	The booklet says an unemployment allowance is payable if work is not provided within 15 days of a household's application.

Lok Adalat basics

1	A. 1982	The booklet states the first Lok Adalat in India was organised in Gujarat in 1982.
2	D. Legal Services Authorities Act, 1987	Lok Adalats have been given statutory status under the Legal Services Authorities Act, 1987.
3	C. A is true but R is false	Offences that are non-compoundable under any law fall outside the purview of Lok Adalat.

4	C. I-C, II-D, III-B, IV-A	Permanent Lok Adalats handle public utility disputes, National Lok Adalat is held on a single day, and the CJI is NALSA's Patron-in-Chief.
5	B. I and II only	Statement III describes FASTER, whereas SUPACE collects relevant facts and laws and makes them available to a judge.
6	B. Only two	Statement II is wrong because Permanent Lok Adalats have no jurisdiction over offences not punishable by law.
7	D. State of Punjab vs Jalour Singh (2008)	The booklet cites State of Punjab vs Jalour Singh (2008) for holding that a Lok Adalat is purely conciliatory.
8	A. Fast and Secured Transmission of Electronic Records	FASTER stands for Fast and Secured Transmission of Electronic Records, a secure channel for communicating orders to authorities.

Assam Bill: practice MCQs

1	A. Meghalaya	Meghalaya has the highest polygamy rate in India at 6.1 per cent in NFHS-5 (2019-21).
2	D. Validates pre-law marriages compliant with personal or customary laws	The Grandfather Clause validates pre-law marriages that comply with personal or customary laws.
3	C. I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C	The correct pairs are I-A (10 years), II-B (NFHS-5), III-C (Section 82 of the BNS) and IV-D (Article 342).
4	A. I and II only	Statement III is incorrect because the bar also covers benefits and electoral participation, while I and II are correct.
5	B. Only two	The Bill bars convicted individuals from electoral participation, so only statements I and II are correct.
6	D. State Victim Relief Fund	The Bill introduces the State Victim Relief Fund to compensate women affected by polygamous marriages.
7	A. Family law ensuring monogamous marriages	The Bill aims to strengthen family law that ensures monogamous marriages.

Why the rupee weakened in 2025

1	D. Gold, electronics, crude and machinery	The booklet lists increased imports of gold, electronics, crude and machinery as widening the trade deficit and amplifying USD demand.
2	A. Foreign Portfolio Investors (FPIs)	The booklet states that Foreign Portfolio Investors (FPIs) withdrew funds aggressively, causing capital outflows.
3	C. 50%	The booklet cites steep US tariffs of up to 50% on Indian exports, which reduced their competitiveness.
4	B. I-D, II-C, III-B, IV-A	The booklet links FPI withdrawals to capital outflows, higher crude prices to a worse import bill, front-loaded purchases to speculative demand, and trade deal delays to tariff and export concerns.
5	C. I and II only	The booklet supports statements I and II, while higher crude oil prices worsened the import bill rather than reducing it (statement III).
6	B. Only two	Statements I and III match the booklet, while II wrongly names exporters (the booklet says importers) and IV misstates the tariff, which is up to 50%.
7	D. Over 5%	The booklet says the rupee depreciated over 5% in 2025 as it crossed 90 per US dollar.

Repo Cut and Goldilocks: MCQ Practice

1	B. Only two	Statements I and III are correct, while the quorum is four members and decisions are by majority vote, so only two statements hold.
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2	C. 25 basis points	The booklet states the RBI cut the repo rate by 25 basis points in December 2025.
3	D. 0.3%	Inflation dipped to 0.3% in October 2025, well below the 2% lower tolerance band.
4	A. I and II only	Statement III is incorrect because the Bank Rate is a long-term rate, while the repo rate is the short-term one.
5	C. 125 basis points	The December 2025 cut was the 4th reduction in 2025, totalling 125 basis points.
6	D. I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C	Repo rate is the rate RBI lends to banks (D), Bank Rate is the long-term lending rate (A), CRR is the cash deposit share (B), and MSF is the overnight window (C).

Summit economics and payments

1	A. External Affairs Minister of India	The text states the IRIGC-TEC is chaired by India's External Affairs Minister and Russia's Deputy Prime Minister.
2	C. \$100 billion	Programme 2030 sets a trade target of \$100 billion by 2030, against \$68.7 billion in 2024-25.
3	C. SWIFT	The text says work on payment-system interoperability and CBDCs aims to bypass Western financial systems such as SWIFT.
4	B. Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A	Russia formally joined the Big Cat Alliance and India welcomed Russia's interest in the Solar Alliance, but the two facts are unrelated.
5	B. I-C, II-D, III-A, IV-B	Programme 2030 diversifies ties beyond defence and energy, payment work bypasses SWIFT, the trade target is \$100 billion and Kudankulam is built with Russian cooperation.
6	D. I and II only	Statements I and II are correct, while the trade of \$68.7 billion in 2024-25 shows that the \$100 billion target has not been reached.
7	B. Only two	Statements I and III are correct, while II wrongly claims formal membership of the Solar Alliance and IV confuses the 2024-25 trade figure with the target.
8	C. 40 per cent	The corridor is aimed at reducing transportation time to Russia by 40 per cent.

The Durand Line Border

1	D. Durand Agreement	The Durand Agreement of 1893 between Sir Henry Mortimer Durand and Emir Abdur Rahman Khan drew the line.
2	D. Treaty of Rawalpindi	The Treaty of Rawalpindi ended the 1919 war and restored Afghanistan's foreign policy autonomy.
3	A. A strategic buffer separating British and Russian spheres	The booklet says the Wakhan Corridor was created as a strategic buffer to separate British and Russian spheres of influence.
4	C. 1947	The booklet says Pakistan inherited the Durand Line after Partition, from 1947 onwards.
5	C. I-B, II-D, III-A, IV-C	Gandamak (1879) gave Britain control of foreign affairs, Rawalpindi (1919) restored autonomy, and the 1893 agreement drew the line.
6	B. I and II only	Afghanistan refused to formally recognise the line, so statement III is incorrect while I and II are supported by the booklet.

Courts, Waqf and Competition Law

1	D. Article 129, for the Supreme Court	Article 129 makes the Supreme Court a Court of Record with power to punish for its own contempt, while Article 215 covers High Courts.
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2	B. Contempt of Courts Act, 1971	The Contempt of Courts Act, 1971 governs contempt proceedings in India.
3	C. A is true but R is false	Criminal contempt covers acts that lower a court's authority, whereas wilful disobedience of a court order is civil contempt.
4	B. I-D, II-A, III-B, IV-C	Article 129 is for the Supreme Court, Article 215 for High Courts, the CCI under the Competition Act 2002, and UMEED under the Waqf Act 1995.
5	C. I and II only	Statement III is wrong because the CCI was established in 2003, not 2002.
6	B. Only two	Statement II is wrong because the Ministry of Minority Affairs is the nodal agency for UMEED, while I and III are correct.
7	D. IndiGo	The CCI took cognisance of IndiGo flight disruptions to probe a possible abuse of dominant position.

Type-in-the-answer passages

Restoring the Green Cover

1	1.1	The booklet sets a target to restore 1.1 million hectares by 2027.
2	2019	The booklet states that the Green Wall Project was launched in 2019.
3	29	The booklet says the project covers 29 districts across Haryana, Rajasthan, Gujarat and Delhi.
4	National Mission for a Green India	The booklet lists the National Mission for a Green India as part of the National Action Plan on Climate Change.
5	Ek Ped Maa Ke Naam	The booklet says the Matri Van Initiative develops the 750-acre urban forest under the Ek Ped Maa Ke Naam programme.
6	26	The booklet says India aims to restore 26 million hectares of degraded or deforested land by 2030 under the Bonn Challenge Pledge.

Planning and schemes check

1	100	The booklet states MGNREGA provided a legal guarantee of at least 100 days of wage employment annually.
2	60	The booklet gives a 60:40 Centre-State share for States and UTs, so the Centre bears 60 per cent.
3	15	The booklet says MGNREGA mandates wages be paid within 15 days of work completion.
4	VB-NRIS	The booklet says plans are aggregated through the Viksit Bharat National Rural Infrastructure Stack (VB-NRIS).
5	PM Gati Shakti	The booklet states that VGPPs are integrated with PM Gati Shakti for infrastructure convergence.
6	SVAMITVA	The booklet says SVAMITVA provides property cards to rural households.
7	2005	The booklet states that MGNREGA was enacted in 2005.

Types of Lok Adalat

1	2002	The booklet states the 1987 Act was amended in 2002 to permit Permanent Lok Adalats.
2	2	A Permanent Lok Adalat has its chairperson plus two other persons with adequate experience in public utility services.

3	Telegraph	The booklet names transportation and telegraph as public utility services handled by Permanent Lok Adalats.
4	National Legal Services Authority	The booklet lists the National Legal Services Authority as the organising authority for Lok Adalats.
5	2008	The booklet dates the case State of Punjab vs Jalour Singh to 2008.
6	2015	The booklet states that since 2015, National Lok Adalat has been held on a specific matter every month.
7	Gujarat	The booklet states the first Lok Adalat in India was organised in Gujarat in 1982.

UCC and courts: short answers

1	44	Article 44 under the Directive Principles places the duty to implement uniform civil laws on the state.
2	Special Marriage Act	The Special Marriage Act 1954 allows inter-religious marriages while explicitly prohibiting polygamy.
3	Concurrent List	Personal laws were placed in the Concurrent List, which allows both Parliament and State Assemblies to legislate.
4	Goa	The Supreme Court hailed Goa as a shining example of an Indian State with a functioning UCC.
5	Shayara Bano	Shayara Bano vs Union of India (2017) held talaq-e-biddat unconstitutional.
6	82	Section 82 of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita 2023 addresses marrying again during the lifetime of a spouse.

Ways to steady the rupee

1	Special Vostro Rupee Accounts	The booklet's first measure is to increase Special Vostro Rupee Accounts for rupee-based trade settlement.
2	UPI	The booklet lists expanding UPI internationalisation as a measure to boost global acceptance of INR.
3	IMF	The booklet mentions working towards INR's eligibility for the IMF SDR basket.
4	5	The section is numbered 1 to 5, with point 5 covering domestic macroeconomic reforms.
5	Digital Gold	The booklet proposes reducing gold imports via gold monetisation and digital gold.
6	G-Secs	The booklet proposes pushing for inclusion of Indian G-Secs in global bond indices to deepen the global market for INR.
7	Africa	The booklet names Asia, Africa and the Gulf as regions for local currency settlement agreements.

MPC and Inflation Targeting: Typed Answer

1	6	The booklet describes the MPC as a six-member committee.
2	4	The MPC is required to meet at least four times in a year.
3	Governor	The RBI Governor has a casting vote when the votes are equal.
4	Urjit Patel Committee	The Urjit Patel Committee (2014) formalised a 4% inflation target with a 2% band.
5	4	The inflation target is 4%, with a deviation of +/- 2%.
6	2016	The booklet states that India adopted flexible inflation targeting in 2016.

7	2	The target of 4% carries a deviation of +/- 2%, giving a range of 2% to 6%.
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Defence and logistics facts

1	36	Russia was India's main supplier of defence equipment, with a 36% share.
2	1993	The new Treaty of Friendship and Cooperation was signed in 1993 after the Soviet Union dissolved.
3	INS Vikramaditya	The text states the refurbished Admiral Gorshkov was transferred to the Indian Navy as INS Vikramaditya.
4	BrahMos	BrahMos is a cruise missile jointly developed by DRDO and NPOM.
5	HAL	The Su-30MKI is produced in India by Hindustan Aeronautics Limited (HAL).
6	3028	The corridor saves 3,028 nautical miles in distance and up to 16 days in time.

Finance, Bonds and Cess

1	RBI	The booklet lists the RBI as the body governing masala bonds.
2	2014	The booklet says the IFC introduced masala bonds in 2014 on the London Stock Exchange.
3	56	The booklet says PMJDY (2014) enabled opening of over 56 crore bank accounts.
4	100	The booklet says the FDI limit in Indian insurance companies is raised from 74% to 100%.
5	5	The booklet says the RBI strategy defines 5 key pillars for the next five years.
6	Divisible Pool	The booklet shows that general taxes are shared with states through the Divisible Pool, unlike surcharges.
7	Pan Masala	The booklet lists Pan Masala, a product associated with high health burdens, as initial coverage of the cess.

Repo Cut, D-SIBs and Economic Census

1	5.25	The RBI cut the repo rate by 25 basis points to 5.25%.
2	20	The Integrated Ombudsman Scheme 2021 allows compensation of up to 20 lakh for financial loss.
3	Too Big To Fail	D-SIBs are referred to as Too Big To Fail.
4	Reserve Bank of India	The Reserve Bank of India designates each D-SIB and places it in a risk bucket.
5	3	The Integrated Ombudsman Scheme 2021 merges the Banking Ombudsman Scheme 2006, the NBFC Ombudsman Scheme 2018 and the Ombudsman Scheme for Digital Transactions 2019.
6	2027	India will conduct the next Economic Census in 2027, after completing the two-phase population census.